



POSITION DESCRIPTION

WNA Board Member Board Chair

Lead Member • [Term] • V1

AT A GLANCE

ROLE TYPE Supervisor role	TIME COMMITMENT [hrs]/week
TERM [Term length]	LOCATION All Meetings / Events

The Board Chair role description includes your responsibilities as Board Chair, including agenda setting, meeting facilitation, Oregon nonprofit compliance, and notices.

Overview

Position Description

As Board Chair, or board president, you are responsible for many important association responsibilities both during and between meetings. These responsibilities include but are not limited to: responding to public inquiries, facilitating meetings, team-building, board member accountability, teaching new board members their roles.

This packet contains a description of your role as Board Chair and resources to aid you in the process.

Responsibilities

Leadership

Neighborhood associations exist for community outreach; as Board Chair, you should be approachable, available, and active in the community. Take the initiative! Cultivate relationships among board members, keep a healthy work environment for the board, and hold everyone accountable for their responsibilities. Neighborhood associations are volunteer driven, and it is your responsibility to keep the board connected and active.

Agenda setting and notification

You will prepare the associating meeting agendas for general, board, and special meetings. You are also responsible for using proper notification protocols once meeting agendas and any additional documents are prepared.

Here are some resources for setting agendas and notification requirements:

- Tips for Preparing a Successful Agenda [hyperlink]
- Sample Agenda [hyperlink]
- Notification Requirements [hyperlink]

Meeting facilitation

You will conduct effective, productive, accessible, and welcoming board meetings. Guide discussions to stay on topic, encourage participation, and follow [association bylaws](#).

Here is the overview for meeting facilitation [hyperlink].

Agenda Setting

A successful meeting only happens if you have a successful agenda. As Board Chair, you are responsible for taking board input and using your own judgement to create meeting agendas. The agenda is a time-tracker, an outline, and a guide to facilitating a success meeting.

OUTLINE FOR AGENDA SETTING

An agenda is a way to communicate the elements and topics of a meeting. Typically, a meeting will have items that occur in every meeting, called “general business” or “standing items”, and items that change depending on community interests and concerns. Here is an agenda outline for a Woodlawn Neighborhood Association (WNA) general meeting:

Before beginning an agenda, consider the date, time, and location of the meeting. Utilize our [meeting minutes template](#) and fill out the relevant metadata.

General business

WNA meetings typically frontload community projects and involvement to respect the time of community attendees. Board business is saved for the end of the meeting as it doesn't involve the community as directly, and can occasionally go over the allotted time for a meeting.

1. Standing Items

- a. Welcome and introductions: WNA meetings usually start with a round 10 minutes of introductions. This allows attendees to meet the board and one another. Everyone at the meeting should have the opportunity to introduce themselves. This time also allows attendees to filter in late without disrupting more significant portions of the meeting.
 - i. Greet newcomers and have everyone introduce themselves at every meeting.
 - ii. Consider posing icebreaker questions like, ‘where are you from, where do you live, where do you work?’.
 - iii. Introductions are always optional, signify this to the meeting.
- b. Ground Rules and Voting Procedures: explaining voting procedures and setting ground rules keeps attendees informed and the meeting running smoothly.
 - i. You determine the degree of participation at meetings. All WNA meetings

must be observable and open to public viewing. [Here](#) is our process for running hybrid WNA meetings.

- c. Approval of Agenda and Past Minutes: The board should approve the meeting agenda and past meeting minutes.
 - i. Provide an overview of the agenda to attendees and offer justification for any changes or additions.
 - ii. Motion for the board to approve the meeting agenda.
 - iii. Ask for any further revisions to past minutes and seek a motion to approve the meeting minutes.
2. Community Items
- a. Board Positions (as needed): If there are any board seats that remain unfilled, or any board positions that are due to change, provide information about the roles or respective changes.
 - i. Need more information about how we approve and select board positions.
 - b. Community Projects: Allocate time to discuss any current projects that the board is working on, or community projects that directly involve the board. If community members are running events, allow them to present.
 - i. Try to time every section of agendas minute by minute, which will change depending on community activity. Keep summaries as short as possible.
 - ii. Always provide ways for community members to contribute to projects. This can be word of mouth, online sign-up sheets, or physical volunteer sheets.
 - c. Open Comments and Concerns: Reserve some time at the end of 'general business' for open comments, where any community member can have the floor to discuss any concerns they may have.
 - i. Best practice is to have community members reach out to you in advance about concerns they would like to bring up as to adjust the time needed for this section accordingly.

Board business

WNA meetings save the organizational board elements of a meeting for the end, and they are completely optional for community attendees. Board business is important to keep the

board aligned in their goals, aware of their progress, and organized.

3. Board Reports: These are the bulk of board business. They are integral to the sharing of information about the board and its progress.
 - a. Allocate minutes for each board position to give their monthly report.
 - b. The board positions are:
 - i. Treasurer
 - ii. Farmer's Market Rep
 - iii. Secretary
 - iv. Outreach and Community Engagement
 - v. Land Use and Transportation
 - vi. Board Chair
4. Final Topics and Future Meetings: This time is for any final comments. Usually these are reminders about upcoming events, meetings, potential financial deadlines, or upcoming plans.
 - a. If applicable, you can also use this term to briefly discuss what topics will be brought up at the next WNA meeting.

AGENDA FORMATTING BEST PRACTICES

Most of the formatting is done for you through our template, but there are a few strategies for creating effective agendas.

Time allocations

Specify how much time is allocated to each agenda item. This also means timing and guiding discussion to stay aligned with this schedule.

Context and anticipated outcomes

In the agenda, include presenter names, topics, and requested outcomes or actions. If applicable, you can include links to background information or resources.

Sequencing

Consider which items should be put first in the agenda. Put topics from guest presenters, or any items that require a vote first.

Standard items

Keep standard items like ground rules and procedures concise. They should be read at the start of every meeting, but that doesn't mean they have to take more than a few minutes.

Planning

Plan your agenda **at least** two weeks in advance. Ask board members for agenda items and sort through requests for time early to keep meetings organized and on time.

Finalization

Send notice of the agenda at least one week in advance of the meeting to comply with city policy. (See [ONI Standards](#) and [Oregon Nonprofit Corporation Act](#))

65.214 NOTICE OF MEETING

(a) The corporation notifies the corporation's members of the place, date and time of each meeting in accordance with ORS 65.034 no fewer than seven days before the meeting;

Sample Meeting Agenda

For this online format, we provided a link to a previous WNA meeting agenda.

[Sample Meeting Agenda](#) [link this later]

Notifications for Meetings

In order to stay compliant with Oregon law, all WNA meetings are required to be open to the public in accessible locations, and we are required to provide both general and direct notification of meetings. As Board Chair, the responsibility to meet these requirements. Whether you handle meeting notification directly or delegate it, the necessary information must be provided to the community.

WHAT NEEDS TO BE IN A NOTICE?

As stated above in [finalization](#), there are required elements in notifications for neighborhood associations, but as a reminder, they are:

- Date and Time of Meeting
- Location of Meeting
- Brief Description of Agenda Topics

Notification Based on Meeting Type

Depending on the kind of meeting held, there are different requirements for how and when you should supply notification. This section outlines the minimum requirements set by the Office of Community & Civic Life for ONI standards. The WNA follows these policies as a baseline, with more specific information listed in our [bylaws](#).

GENERAL, BOARD, SPECIAL & COMMITTEE MEETINGS

General notice

Notice to the general public and board or committee members must be given a minimum of seven (7) days before the meeting. We encourage more notice than this, with recurring reminders.

General notice methods

- Website

- Email
- Newsletter
- Other social media
- Door-to-door flyers
- Public bulletin boards or kiosks
- Online community calendars

Direct notice

Direct notice must be given a minimum of twenty four (24) hours before the meeting to people who have requested notice. Direct notice is also needed for applicants in land use and liquor license reviews when their issue is on the agenda for the meeting.

Direct notice methods

- By hand
- Mail
- Email
- Telephone (only if other methods are not practical)

EMERGENCY MEETINGS

What is an emergency meeting?

Emergency meetings are called when decisions need to be made in less than the standard seven (7) days' notice. The emergency matter at hand is the **only** topic that may be discussed at the meeting. Refer to the [bylaws](#) for specific procedures for calling an emergency meeting. (CHECK BYLAWS AN INSERT INFORMATION HERE LATER)

General and direct notice

A minimum of twenty four (24) hours' notice is required to the public as well as members of the board or committee and any parties involved in the topic of the meeting. Direct notice should still be delivered by [direct notice methods](#).

Meeting Facilitation

The key to meeting facilitation is keeping meetings on time, on task, and on the same page. Facilitation takes time and practice, and every Board Chair has their own style and organization. Frequently ask for feedback and suggestions from your fellow board members and attendees to find ways to improve your meetings. Meetings that run on time and are effective will help the WNA make decisions, and show that you respect the time and energy of everyone involved.

8 Tips for Meeting Facilitation

BE PREPARED

Plan the agenda and make sure notice has gone out at least one week prior to the meeting. Contact presenters to make sure they will be attending. Reach out to fellow board members to ensure that all tasks are covered and everyone understands their specific roles/responsibilities.

KNOW YOUR GROUND RULES

Always state ground rules at the beginning of meetings. This is both to remind your board and general membership. Your meeting has a better chance of running smoothly if everyone understands the way the meeting will be run, what will be tolerated, and what won't.

FACILITATE VOTING AND DEISION-MAKING

Never assume an agreement has been reached without a vote. The Board Chair should review how voting works when needed during meetings. Make sure people know who is allowed to vote at the beginning of meetings.

STAY ON TIME

It is often helpful to assign the role of timekeeper to another board member so that time will be better monitored. Remember, your agenda should be written minute-by-minute, so you can refer to it during the meeting to enforce strict time limits on topics.

DIRECT THE DISCUSSION AND STAY ON TOPIC

If information is being repeated in a meeting, or is getting off topic, recap the information and realign the meeting. If a decision needs to be made, call for a motion from the group.

ALWAYS MAINTAIN YOUR ROLE AS BOARD CHAIR

Facilitate group discussions, making sure all are being heard. Part of your responsibility, however, is not to abuse your position or monopolize your time on the floor.

WRAP-UP AT THE END OF THE MEETING

Briefly review all key decisions made and restate action items. Don't forget to acknowledge any new faces in the room and remind them to sign in (and up for the newsletter!).

FOLLOW-UP AFTER THE MEETING

Offer help to other board members as needed and make a plan for connecting with any new members.

Emphasizing Inclusion

These are some tips for ensuring everyone involved in WNA meetings feels heard, seen, and is free to participate.

- Minimize crosstalk.
- Consider the needs of different cultures and personalities in your meetings.
- Be flexible and allow for questions to ensure understanding.
- Control the flow of discussion and guide your group to making decisions and reaching consensus.
- Summarize the discussion so that others have a sense of conclusion.
- Address disruptive influences to make meetings more accessible, welcoming, and productive.
- Don't allow others to take over the meeting through intimidation, anger, outrageous behavior, or filibustering.
- Set boundaries, but validate participants' contributions. (ex. 'I see that you are frustrated about this issue. Maybe we can talk about it after today's meeting?')

Robert's Rules of Order

At WNA, we use a combination of Robert's Rules of Order and Bob's Rules of Order. All they are are general rules for meeting procedure. They exist to facilitate discussion and decision-making. They help meetings run smoothly and efficiently. The rules can get a little complicated, so we are offering a simplified version here for your use, starting with a glossary of terms.

"Make a motion"

A motion is a formal proposal by a board member to take an action or make a decision. Motions are made to gain agreement on a topic of discussion. They can also be used to change topics or progress in a meeting.

"Second a motion"

Seconding a motion indicates agreement with a motion that another member proposed.

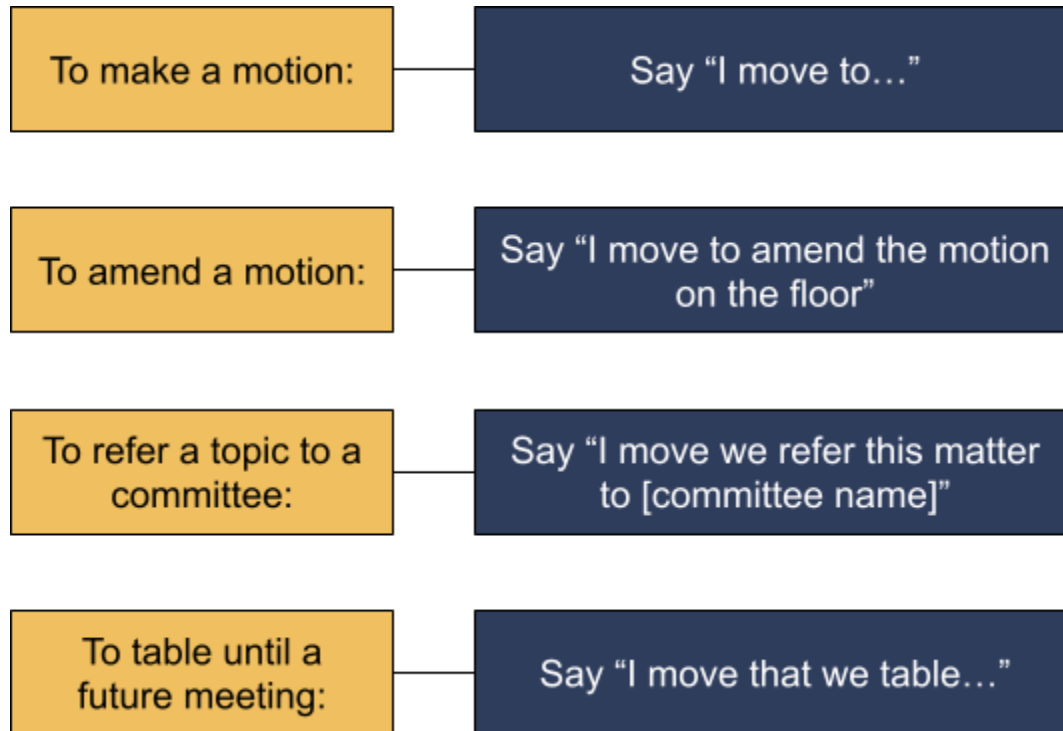
"Call a vote"

Calling a vote gathers a count of who agrees and disagrees with the motion; and those who do not wish to vote. Choosing not to vote is also called abstention.

Utilizing Robert's Rules

As Board Chair, you are responsible for facilitating discussion and votes. Here is an outline of how to utilize Robert's Rules.

[in full on next page]



Regardless of the motion, after it is stated:

- Another board member needs to second the motion; AND
- The Board Chair repeats the motion verbatim; AND
- Opportunity for further discussion is provided; AND
- A vote is called by the Board Chair (ex. 'All in favor say aye, those opposed say nay, abstentions? Or ask for a show of hands).
- Vote is summarized by the Board Chair and recorded by the secretary.

EXAMPLE MOTION AND VOTING PROCEDURE

Linde: "I move to approve the minutes of the last meeting"

Joy: "I second that motion"

Board Chair (you): "It has been moved and seconded that we approve the minutes of the last meeting." (motion must be repeated verbatim)

Board Chair (you): "Is there any further discussion on the approval of last meeting's minutes?"

[At this point, discussion will ensue. If no further discussion is desired, or when discussion has ended, the Board Chair will proceed with the vote.]

Board Chair (you): “All those in favor say ‘aye’. All those not in favor say ‘nay’. Are there any abstentions?” [Alternatively] “Show of hands who is in favor. Show of hands who is not in favor.”

Board Chair (you): “[provide a summary declaration of the vote, whether it passed or not.]”

If all board members are in favor, the motion passes unanimously.

Bob's Rules

Bob's rules are less structured, more interpersonal guidelines for discussion, but they are equally important to WNA conduct. They are as follows.

- Respect others and their opinions.
- Do not interrupt others.
- Try to make your point in 25 words or less.
- Speak only to the topic at hand.
- No side conversations.
- When an idea has been stated previously and you agree, only speak when you have something new to contribute.
- Everyone gets a chance to share their opinion before someone speaks again.
- Speaking briefly and staying focused is everyone's responsibility. This will make the meeting run smoothly.
- These rules belong to everyone, and everyone is responsible for seeing that they are followed.

Questions? Email info@gowoodlawn.com